

Data Governance Policy

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1.0	2020-05-15	IT Dept	Initial high-level policy drafted by IT	CDO
2.0	2022-02-01	Ahmed Al-Rashid	Major rewrite to align with newly released NDMO V1	CDO
2.1	2022-08-10	Fatima Al-Zahrani	Updated Data Quality section to include automated checks	CDO
3.0	2023-01-01	Fatima Al-Zahrani	Annual Review. Restructured document to match the 1	CDO

3.1	2024-01-01	Fatima Al-Zahrani	Integration of AI governance principles and update
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Approval

This policy constitutes a mandatory directive for all Company A employees and contractors.

Reviewed By:

Name	Role	Signature	Date
Fatima Al-Zahrani	Data Governance Manager	[Signed]	2023-12-10
Ahmed Al-Rashid	Chief Data Officer	[Signed]	2023-12-15
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Approved By:

Name	Role	Signature	Date
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1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

1.1 Policy Overview

In the modern digital era, data is as critical to Company A as our financial capital and human resources. The Data Governance Policy serves as the constitution for how this asset is managed, protected, and leveraged. It moves the organization from ad-hoc data handling to a structured, disciplined environment where data is treated as a strategic national asset.

This policy mandates strict adherence to the National Data Management Office (NDMO) regulations and the Personal Data Protection Law (PDPL). It applies to every byte of data generated, stored, or processed by Company A, regardless of its format (digital or physical) or location (on-premise or cloud).

At its core, this policy establishes:

1. Accountability: Every data element has a clear owner.
2. Quality: Meaningful standards are enforced to ensure trust.
3. Security: Access is controlled based on classification.
4. Transparency: Metadata is cataloged and made available.

1.2 Business Value

Implementation of this policy delivers tangible value:

- Risk Reduction: By classifying data and enforcing access controls, we reduce the risk of breaches and regulatory fines (which can reach SAR 5M under PDPL).

- Operational Efficiency: By standardizing definitions, we eliminate the 30% of time analysts spend "cleaning" data.
- Trusted Decisions: Executives can rely on reports ("One Version of the Truth") without needing to cross-verify multiple spreadsheets.

2. INTRODUCTION

2.1 Purpose

The purpose of the Data Governance Policy is to:

- Formalize the data governance organizational structure.
- Define roles, responsibilities, and decision-making rights.
- Establish mandatory principles for the 15 data management domains.
- Ensure compliance with KSA laws (Vision 2030, NDMO, NCA, PDPL).

2.2 Scope & Applicability

This policy applies to:

- People: All employees, contractors, consultants, and third-party vendors accessing Company A data.
- Assets: All information systems, databases, data lakes, document repositories, and physical archives.
- Lifecycle: From the moment data is created or acquired until it is securely destroyed.

Exclusions:

- Personal notes not related to company business.
- Transient data held in volatile memory (RAM) that is not persisted.

2.3 Authority & Constraints

This policy derives its authority from the CEO Decree #2023-05 establishing the Data Management Office.

- Primacy: In the event of a conflict between this policy and a Departmental procedure, this policy takes precedence.
- Regulatory Conflict: If this policy conflicts with a National Regulation (e.g., Royal Decree), the Regulation takes precedence.

3. DATA GOVERNANCE FRAMEWORK

3.1 The Three Lines of Defense Model

Company A adopts a standard risk management model for data governance:

1. First Line (Business Operations): owning and managing risks.
 - Who: Data Stewards, Data Owners, Data Creators.
 - Role: executing the policy in daily operations (e.g., entering data correctly).
2. Second Line (Oversight Functions): Overseeing risks.
 - Who: Data Management Office (DMO), Information Security (CISO), Legal.
 - Role: Defining policies, monitoring compliance, and providing tools.
3. Third Line (Independent Assurance): Providing independent assurance.
 - Who: Internal Audit Department.
 - Role: Auditing the effectiveness of the DMO and Business operations.

3.2 Governance Domains (NDMO Alignment)

This framework covers all 15 NDMO domains:

1. Data Governance: The "umbrella" domain (This Policy).
2. Data Catalog: The inventory of assets.
3. Data Quality: Fitness for use.
4. Data Operations: Lifecycle management.
5. Document Management: Unstructured content.
6. Data Architecture: Blueprints and models.
7. Master Data: Shared critical entities (Customer, Product).
8. BI & Analytics: Reporting.
9. Data Sharing: Integration.
10. Open Data: Public publishing.
11. Freedom of Information: Right to access.
12. Data Classification: Sensitivity labelling.
13. Data Protection: Security controls.
14. Personal Data Protection: Privacy rights.
15. Data Monetization: Value generation.

4. ROLES & RESPONSIBILITIES

4.1 Data Governance Committee (DGC)

Chairperson: Chief Data Officer (CDO)

Frequency: Monthly

Composition: C-Level Executives (CIO, CPO, CFO, HR Director, Ops Director)

Responsibilities:

1. Strategy Approval: Approve the multi-year Data Strategy and annual roadmap.
2. Policy Ratification: Review and sign off on all enterprise data policies before CEO approval.
3. Conflict Resolution: Serve as the "Supreme Court" for data disputes (e.g., Finance and Sales disagreeing on the definition of "Revenue").
4. Investment Prioritization: Allocate budget (e.g., the SAR 3.5M portfolio) to high-impact data initiatives.

4.2 Chief Data Officer (CDO)

Current Holder: Ahmed Al-Rashid

Responsibilities:

1. Program Leadership: Lead the Data Management Office (DMO).
2. Compliance Owner: Accountable to the Regulator (NDMO) for Company A's compliance status.
3. Culture Builder: Drive data literacy and awareness programs across the entity.
4. Advisor: Advise the CEO on data-driven innovation and AI opportunities.

4.3 Data Management Office (DMO)

Responsibilities:

1. Standard Setting: Write standards (Naming, Metadata, Quality).
2. Tool Management: Administer the Data Catalog (Informatica EDC) and Quality Tools (IDQ).
3. Monitoring: Produce the Quarterly Compliance Reports.
4. Support: Mentor and train Data Stewards.

4.4 Business Data Executives (Data Owners)

Definition: Senior executives (typically VP/Director level) accountable for a specific data domain (e.g., HR Director owns "Employee Data").

Responsibilities:

1. Accountability: Ultimately responsible for the quality and security of data in their domain.
2. Access Granting: Authorize (or deny) access requests to their data (especially Confidential/Secret data).
3. Resource Allocation: Appoint Data Stewards from their teams.

4.5 Data Stewards

Definition: Subject Matter Experts (SMEs) embedded in business units who understand the data's meaning and usage.

Key Responsibilities:

1. Metadata Definition: Define business terms in the Glossary. "What does 'Active Customer' mean?"
2. Quality Remediation: Investigate and resolve DQ issues assigned to them.

3. Classification: Label data assets (Public/Secret) according to the framework.
4. Testing: valid data in User Acceptance Testing (UAT) for new systems.

4.6 Data Custodians (IT)

Definition: IT professionals (DBAs, Developers, Admins) responsible for the technical infrastructure.

Responsibilities:

1. Safekeeping: Implement backups, encryption, and access controls.
2. Availability: Ensure databases are up and running (SLA Uptime).
3. Implementation: Execute the technical changes requested by Stewards (e.g., adding a column).

4.7 Data Consumers

Definition: Any employee who uses data to do their job.

Responsibilities:

1. Safe Handling: Do not share passwords or export Confidential data to unapproved devices.
2. Reporting: Report any data errors or security incidents immediately.
3. Ethics: Use personal data only for authorized business purposes.

5. POLICY STATEMENTS BY DOMAIN

5.1 Data Cataloging & Metadata

Policy 5.1.1: All "Production" data stores (Databases, Data Lakes, APIs) MUST be registered in the Enterprise Data Catalog.

Policy 5.1.2: All data assets in the catalog MUST have an assigned Data Owner and Data Steward.

Policy 5.1.3: Business Terms in the Glossary MUST leverage standard naming conventions (Document DM-STD-001).

Evidence: Automated scanner runs weekly to detect unregistered assets.

5.2 Data Quality Management

Policy 5.2.1: All Critical Data Elements (CDEs) MUST have defined Data Quality Rules (Completeness, Accuracy, etc.).

Policy 5.2.2: Data Quality checks MUST be automated and run at minimum weekly.

Policy 5.2.3: Data Quality issues flagged as "High" or "Critical" MUST be remediated within 5 business days.

Policy 5.2.4: No new system may go live with a Data Quality Score below 90%.

5.3 Data Operations & Lifecycle

Policy 5.3.1: Data retention periods MUST be defined for all data categories (Refer to Retention Schedule).

Policy 5.3.2: Data exceeding its retention period MUST be securely disposed of or archived.

Policy 5.3.3: Production data MUST NOT be used in Non-Production environments (Test/Dev) unless irreversibly masked/anonymized.

5.4 Data Security & Privacy

Policy 5.4.1: Access to data is granted on a "Need-to-Know" basis (Least Privilege).

Policy 5.4.2: All data classified as "Confidential" or "Secret" MUST be encrypted at Rest and in Transit.

Policy 5.4.3: Personal Data MUST NOT be collected without a clear legal basis and (where required) explicit consent.

6. COMPLIANCE & ENFORCEMENT

6.1 Compliance Monitoring

The DMO is responsible for monitoring compliance with this policy.

- Method: Automated dashboards (Data Trust Score) + Annual Manual Audit.
- Reporting: Non-compliance is reported quarterly to the DGC.

6.2 Exemptions

- Requests for exemption from any part of this policy must be submitted in writing to the CDO.
- Exemptions are valid for a maximum of 6 months and must be risk-assessed.
- Example: A legacy system that cannot support encryption might get a temporary exemption while a replacement is built.

6.3 Violations

- Failure to comply with this policy may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.
- Violations involving criminal negligence or intentional data theft will be referred to legal authorities.

7. APPENDIX

7.1 RACI Matrix (High Level)

Activity	CDO	Data Owner	Data Steward	Data Custodian	Data User
Define Data Strategy	A/R	C	I	I	I
Approve Policy	A	C	I	I	I
Define Business Term	I	A	R	C	C
Grant Access	I	A/R	C	I	C
Implement Access Control	I	I	I	R	I
Fix Data Quality Issue	I	A	R	C	I
Report Data Issue	I	I	I	I	R

Key: R=Responsible, A=Accountable, C=Consulted, I=Informed

END OF POLICY

Company A - Internal Use Only